

Natali Salazar

Senior Product Designer | Systems thinker who executes the details

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SUMMARY

I started doing UX before the industry had agreed on what to call it — building products in banking and healthcare, learning from engineers, real users, and things that broke as much as from any methodology. That gave me the ability to hold the whole system in view while still getting the details right, knowing which level to work at and when to switch.

After becoming a mother, I took time away from full-time work and used it to deepen the systems and service perspective I'd already built through practice.

Experience has made me skeptical of unnecessary complexity. I still find people more interesting than frameworks.

EXPERIENCE

Career break — Primary Caregiver *Nov 2022 – 2025*

UX Designer — Fresenius Medical Care *Remote | 2016 – 2021*

Worked with engineering leaders and executives to improve internal tools supporting operational processes across a global healthcare organization.

- Worked directly with the CTO to scope and design new features, including a social layer embedded into the internal ticket system — a company-wide feed built into the ops tool to improve internal communication.
- Designed adaptive display layouts for medical center screens that had to work across different resolutions and mounting contexts — a physical environment constraint, not a screen design problem.
- Built a visual design system establishing brand consistency across the product — a second instance of building shared design infrastructure from scratch, this time in a regulated healthcare environment.

Web Designer to UX Designer — Galicia Bank *Buenos Aires, Argentina | 2011 – 2020*

Spent nearly a decade designing products for retail and business banking customers at one of Argentina's largest financial institutions — working under strict regulatory constraints, at scale, with real consequences for every decision.

- Designed online banking experiences used by millions of individuals and businesses, including complex workflows: payroll, bulk transfers, permissions, and role-based account access.
- Learned early that users rarely behave the way teams expect — used Hotjar and Google Analytics to measure landing page performance across campaigns, redesigning hierarchy and CTAs based on what people actually did. Each campaign fed insights into the next.
- Started building reusable components and patterns before "design systems" had a name — initially because developers needed to build screens faster. What began as a practical toolset evolved into a shared system that standardized how the product was built across teams.
- Working closely with marketing taught me that understanding what motivates people often matters more than optimizing screens.
- Experienced the shift to Agile firsthand and learned that working methods shape product outcomes as much as design decisions — which changed how I think about team structure and process ever since.

UX Designer — Freelance *(concurrent with Galicia Bank) | Remote | 2014 – 2020*

Worked independently with clients in e-commerce and hospitality — often as the only designer on the project. Running discovery, research, and delivery without a team forced faster decisions and tighter scope.

- Worked directly with founders and business owners where conversations were as much about business viability as design decisions — a different kind of problem-solving than working inside a large organization.
- Applied methods like Design Sprints to compress discovery and move clients toward testable ideas quickly.
- Balanced speed with enough validation to avoid solving the wrong problem.

PROJECTS

Airport Dining Experience — Service Design Exploration *Remote | Nov 2024 – Jan 2025*

Volunteer project with an international team of four designers. Led the discovery and design process — research synthesis, personas, journey maps, and service blueprints — for a 0→1 airport dining concept. The project didn't ship, but produced a clear opportunity map and design framework grounded in real operational constraints.

SKILLS

Practice: Product Design, Service Design, Design Systems, User Research, Information Architecture, Prototyping, Workshop Facilitation.

Tools: Figma, Maze, Miro.

Technical foundations: HTML, CSS (extensive, 12+ years)

EDUCATION

- **Bachelor's Degree in Graphic Design** — University of Buenos Aires (UBA), 2008
- **Specialisation in Technique and Logic of Form** — University of Buenos Aires (UBA), 2010

CERTIFICATIONS

Took both during my career break to deepen the systems and holistic thinking I'd built through practice.

- **Human-Centered Service Design** — IDEO U, 2023
- **Product Management Immersion** — CareerFoundry, 2024

LANGUAGES

Spanish: Native · English: Professional